

Case rules — MSD

Every case runs the same way. Read this once. Each case sheet only adds what is specific to that case.

The day

Three slots of 90 minutes, in the room.

	Slot	What happens
1	Recitation	The method for this block. Every team shows its draft
2	Group work	You finish the slides and draft the report
3	Presentations	You present. We ask questions

Before the day

On your own — read the case and take fact notes: what the case *says*, with the page or exhibit it says it on. Write down what it does **not** tell you.

As a team — bring a **draft presentation** to slot 1. Five lines is enough, on a laptop or on paper. Nothing to upload.

Recommendation: <one sentence>

Because 1: ...

Because 2: ...

Because 3: ...

Deliverables

Two deadlines, both PDF on Moodle.

- **Slides**, 8 maximum — due **before slot 3 starts**. You present from what you submitted.
- **Report**, 5 pages maximum — due **the Friday one week later, 23:59**. Shorter is better.

Late: -0.5 within the same day, then -1 per day. Not uploaded at all: that artefact scores zero, so a missing report costs all 5 points. If a case has a different report date — a reading week, say — it is announced on Moodle.

Slide format

- **White background, black text**. No template, no logo. An image only when the image *is* the evidence.
- The title of a slide is the **claim**, not a label. “Nobody owns the design decision”, not “Problem analysis”.
- At most 6 bullets, at most 12 words each. 24 pt minimum.
- Tag every line **[F]** or **[A]**. A **fact** is in the case — give the page or exhibit. An **assumption** is what you inferred because the case is silent. Where an assumption carries your recommendation, say what changes if it is wrong.

Slide order — your answer comes first

1	Title	team, members, who did what
2	Recommendation	one sentence, then what changes
3-6	Why	one reason per slide, its [F] and [A] beneath it 2 to 4 reasons – the logic decides, not a convention
7	What we do	who, by when, how we know it worked
8	What could go wrong	the risk that would change your answer
	backup slides go after	slide 8, are not presented and do not count

Report

The same argument in sentences, in the same order. 5 pages maximum for the body, 11–12 pt, not counting the title page, references and appendix.

It does not have to repeat the presentation. It is due a week later on purpose: you will have been cross-examined and seen how other teams read the same case. If that changed your mind, change the answer and say what changed it — updating on evidence scores better than defending a position you no longer hold.

Every claim cites something — the case with its page or exhibit, or a named lecture, reading or MSDBOK page. Reference list at the end. An uncited claim is an opinion, and opinions score nothing.

Assumptions are the exception. They cite nothing, because the case is silent — that is what makes them assumptions. Mark each one, either with the **[A]** tag or in the sentence itself: *“We assume no spare tester is available, because the case lists none.”* Say what each one rests on, and what changes if it turns out to be wrong. An assumption written as though it were a fact is graded as a wrong fact.

How it is graded — 8 points

The same three questions are asked of the presentation and of the report.

	Presentation	Report
Facts are right — traced to the case, and the case really says that	1	2
Assumptions are reasonable — labelled, plausible, and you say what breaks if the load-bearing one is wrong	1	1
Justification logic is correct — answer first; the reasons carry it, each through a named concept from the lectures or readings used correctly; and the plan is concrete enough to start on	1	2
	3	5

Facts come from the case. Logic comes from the course.

Use the concept, don't just name it. *“The team is in storming, so they argue a lot”* names Tuckman but explains nothing — delete the name and the sentence says the same thing. *“Storming predicts they will not reach consensus on the design, so waiting for agreement will not work”* uses it: the concept does the explaining, and it is what makes the recommendation follow. A name that does no work scores half.

What loses points

Every one of these has cost a team points in an earlier cohort.

- More than one root problem, or a list of problems in no particular order.
- Facts on one slide, assumptions on another, and nothing joining either to a claim.
- A verdict on someone's personality or character. Describe the behaviour, cite the case.
- Misreading an exhibit. Check what it measures before you quote it.
- A plan with no owner, no date and no way to tell whether it worked.
- A framework named but not sourced or explained — Goleman, Tuckman, RAPID, 5 Whys.
- Anything that is not in the case, the lectures or the readings.
- Bullets that list without concluding.

Timing and integrity

Your slot is announced on the day — 90 minutes divided by the number of teams, usually about 10 minutes to present and 4 for questions. Overrunning is cut off.

Your team's own work. Cite what you use. The case document is licensed to this course: do not redistribute it.